

Communication Unit Leader Position Checklist

The following checklist should be considered as the minimum requirements for this position. Note that some of the tasks are one-time actions; others are ongoing or repetitive for the duration of the incident.



Task

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1. Obtain briefing from the Logistics Section Chief or Service Branch Director.

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2. Organize and staff Unit as appropriate:

- Assign Communications Center Manager and Lead Incident Dispatcher.
- Assign Message Center Manager and ensure adequate staff is assigned to answer phones and attend fax machines.

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3. Assess communications systems/frequencies in use; advise on communications capabilities/limitations.

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4. Develop and implement effective communications procedures (flow) internal and external to the incident/Incident Command Post.

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5. Assess Incident Command Post phone load and request additional lines as needed.

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6. Prepare and implement Incident Communications Plan (ICS Form 205):

- Obtain current organizational chart.
- Determine most hazardous tactical activity; ensure adequate communications.
- Make communications assignments to all other Operations elements, including volunteer, contract, or mutual aid.
- Determine Command communications needs.
- Determine support communications needs.
- Establish and post any specific procedures for use of Incident Command Post communications equipment.

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7. Include cellular phones and pagers in Incident Communications Plan (ICS Form 205), if appropriate:
- Determine specific organizational elements to be assigned telephones.
 - Identify all facilities/locations with which communications must be established (shelters, press area, liaison area, agency facilities, other governmental entities' Emergency Operations Centers (EOCs), etc.), identify and document phone numbers.
 - Determine which phones/numbers should be used by what personnel and for what purpose. Assign specific telephone numbers for **incoming** calls, and report these numbers to staff and off-site parties such as other local jurisdictions, State and Federal agencies.
 - **Do not publicize OUTGOING call lines.**

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8. Activate, serve as contact point, and supervise the integration of volunteer radio organizations into the communications system.

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9. Ensure radio and telephone logs are available and being used.

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10. Determine need and research availability of additional nets and systems:

- Order through Supply Unit after approval by Section Chief.
- Federal systems:
 - Additional radios and other communications devices, including repeaters, radio-telephone interconnects and satellite down-link capabilities may be available through FEMA or the USDA Forest Service.

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11. Document malfunctioning communications equipment, facilitate repair.

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12. Establish and maintain communications equipment accountability system.

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13. Provide technical information, as required, on:

- Adequacy of communications system currently in use.
- Geographic limitation on communications equipment.
- Equipment capabilities.
- Amount and types of equipment available.
- Anticipated problems in the use of communications equipment.

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14. Estimate Unit needs for expected operations; order relief personnel.

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15. Provide briefing to relief on current activities and unusual situations.

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16. Document all activity on Unit Log (ICS Form 214).